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CONFIDENTIAL

10616/2/8/51

BRITISH EMBASSY,

Washington, D.C.

15th October 1951.

FJ 10310/12

My Dear Rob,

FJ 10310/11

I was very interested to read Bill Dening's letter to you 11910/1259/51 of the 8th October about Japan's future relations with China.

As far as the Americans are concerned I subscribe completely to Dening's view that to hold up ratification would cause annoyance and fail in its object.

One rather amusing result of Dening's conversation with Sebald was a remark made recently to me by John Allison to the effect that "That Machiavellian fellow Bill Dening is already hard at work in Tokyo making sure that the Japanese don't come to terms with Chiang Kai-shek". As you well know, Allison and Bill Dening are old and good friends and the remark was purely jocular; but I have noticed on more than one occasion that when Allison indulges in jests of this kind they often reflect anxiety felt by some of his colleagues which he himself does not happen to share. Incidentally Allison told me some time ago that Dulles had remarked jokingly to him (but I suspect only half in jest) that he had better advance the date of his departure for Tokyo so as not to leave Dening with a clear field for too long!

My own view remains that the State Department (and Dulles) have reached no hard and fast view on the subject of Japan's future relations with China. They consider that Japan would be unwise to make any arrangements with Formosa which purport to be a full Treaty of Peace with China. But their main present anxiety is that the position should not harden until they can see a little more clearly which way (if any) the Congressional cat is likely to jump.

I am copying this letter to Bill Dening.

Yours ever

Tommy

F. S. Tomlinson

R. H. Scott, Esq., C.M.G., C.B.E.,
Foreign Office,
London S.W. 1

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